FESTIVAL ▼

CREATING CONNECTIONS

The Serendipity Arts Festival announces a star-studded line-up of curators for its upcoming 10th edition



KNOWN FOR ITS SCALE AS WELL AS ITS INTERDISCIPLINARY NATURE, **SAF** WILL BE HELD BETWEEN DEC. 12 AND 21 IN PANJIM, GOA

The Serendipity Arts Festival (SAF), the first edition of which was held in Goa in December 2016, is approaching its landmark 10th edition later this year, to be held between December 12 and 21 in Panjim, Goa. SAF is known for its scale as well as its interdisciplinary nature; art, literature, music, theatre, dance, photography, etc. are all represented every year. In that vein, the festival has announced a star-studded line-up of 35+ curators across disciplines, all of whom have been involved with the festival in the past as well—musicians Ehsaan Noorani and Aneesh Pradhan, actor-director Lillete Dubey, curator Rahaab Allana, artist Sudarshan Shetty, poet and cultural theorist Ranjit Hoskote, theatre director Anuradha Kapur and many others.

"As we mark the milestone 10th edition of the Serendipity Arts Festival," said the festival's founder and patron Sunil Kant Munjal during an interview, "we continue to focus on the values of inclusivity, accessibility, diversity, sustainability and collaboration in the arts. When I look at this festival's trajectory, I see a nicely-paced evolution; a relatively modest-sized project (when it began) has become one of the largest interdisciplinary arts festivals in the region. Unlike conventional arts platforms or white-cube spaces that separate art forms, Serendipity encourages cross-pollination between music, dance, theatre, visual arts, craft, photography and culinary arts."

Since the inception of the festival, accessibility has been emphasised at SAF. In the 10th edition, writer and disability activist Salil Chaturvedi will curate acts led by deaf and mute artists and performers. There will also be workshops catering to special needs audiences. The COVID years, especially, were a learning experience for the SAF team, particularly in terms of holding audience interest for sustained periods.

"People need human connection, especially in the digital world," Munjal said. "While digital media and remote setups provide convenience, they've also caused digital fatigue. Conversely, a real journey with the arts can be immersive, restorative and transformative. Watching something on a screen can never quite match the rising heartbeat that comes from watching a moving performance by a person onstage. Yet, cultural events also need to harness the power of the digital world. This helps amplify their reach while staying true to the wonder and marvel of an in-person experience." ■

—Aditya Mani Jha



EXHIBITION ▼

South Asia Unframed

DELHI CONTEMPORARY ART WEEK RETURNS WITH DIVERSE CURATIONS EXPLORING MEMORY, IDENTITY, DISPLACEMENT AND THE INTERSECTIONS OF ART, DESIGN AND LANGUAGE

The 8th edition of the Delhi Contemporary Art Week—a creative alliance forged by six women-led galleries—will once again showcase the best of South Asian art and contemporary voices, with each gallery bringing its unique curatorial vision and artistic strengths.

Blueprint12's presentation will bring together a group of emerging artists whose practices are rooted in a shared exploration of memory, place and the invisible structures—social, political and digital—which shape contemporary life. "We're foregrounding artists who